



The Suicide Squad post-credits scenes

James Gunn has teased that the upcoming movie will have more than one post-credits scene. <http://dgit.in/may21-70>



Son of Kong

Director Adam Wingard is in talks with WB/Legendary for a new monsterverse movie. <http://dgit.in/may21-71>

detective stories and action stories, and fairy tales told to little kiddies. MST was an epic, and the massive story itself was a metacriticism of Tolkien, exploring what exactly the various factions of the world were going through, and crafting more intricate political narratives. Imagine a *Lord of the Rings* story, where you understand more about the motivations of Sauron, we get to explore the society of Orcs, find out more about why they are doing what they are doing. That is exactly what goes on here, we have the *norms*, and we see a few of their machinations, their plans, their schemes, their rigid and inflexible society. They are not just evil for evil's sake, they are a dying race positioned against the rest of the world.

The other thing is that George R. R. Martin was really inspired by just how awesome this was, and decided to adopt the same approach on a much bigger scale, with more countries and more factions. There are a number of historical and fantasy influences on George R. R. Martin, who has not shied away from shout-outs to everything from *Three Stooges* to the *Grateful Dead* so if you pick any fantasy story and say this has influenced GOT, it is probably going to be true. However, during the promotions for *Dance with Dragons*, GRRM directly noted how big of an influence the MST trilogy was. During the event, GRRM said, "Tad's fantasy series, *The Dragonbone Chair* and the rest of his famous four-book trilogy was one of the things that inspired me to write my own seven-book trilogy. I read my Tad and was impressed by him, but the imitators that followed -- well, fantasy got a bad rep for being very formulaic and ritual. And I read *The Dragonbone Chair* and said, 'My god, they can do something with this form,' and it's Tad doing it. It's one of my favorite fantasy series."

There are a bunch of things to unpack here. In the late '80s, fantasy writing had stagnated quite a bit because of formulaic copycats of

Tolkien. What Tad Williams did was usher in a more nuanced world where the good and evil was not so white and black. GRRM continued this, showing the problems with the happily ever after. In an interview with *Rolling Stone*, GRRM explained, "Tolkien doesn't ask the question: What was Aragorn's tax policy?"

Influential as they were, Tad Williams second series actually digs deeper into the society of the *Norms*, the orcs, the others, or the bad people. It is more of the stuff that makes the first series works. The second series though, started with a bonus, a novella that bridges the story between MST and *The Last King of Osten Ard*, a book known as *The Heart of What was Lost*. Now, *The Navigator's Children* might have been delayed, but there is another novella, *Brothers of the Wind* which, according to a

blog post by the author is "the story of *Hakatri* and *Ineluki* and how they slew the dragon *Hidobebbi*", which is a pretty epic episode from the books for those who have read it. For those who have not, start now, there should be just enough time to read all the books in the series so far for the November 2021 release of *Brothers of the Wind*.

Once that is done, there is *The Navigator's Children* to look forward to after that. For all those wondering what the *White Walkers* or the *Others* were all about, and why they were doing what they were doing, reading MST should give you plenty of closure. The similarities extend much beyond the framework, structure and intention of the story, going down to individual characters. There is *Simon Snowlocke* who is *Jon Snow*, and *Marya*, who is *Arya*. Both stories begin with the death of a king, *Prester John* in *Osten*

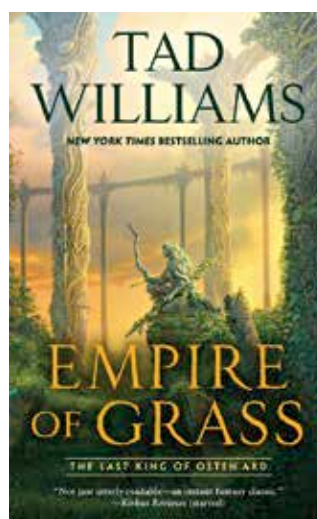
Ard, and *Robert Baratheon* in *Westeros*. Both series have a white knight who lives by the canon and is well respected around the land, *Ser Camaris* in *Osten Ard*, and *Ser Barristan Selmy* in *Westeros*. Then we have the figures who are hunters, *Ingen Jegger* in *Osten Ard* and *The Hound* in *Westeros*. The similarities are unending.

GOT is not the only story inspired by MST. The underlying form used for the story of multiple first person

narratives has now jumped the genre. Daniel Abraham and Ty Franck wrote *The Expanse* series of novels, which is essentially the space version of *Game of Thrones*, which went on to become its own streaming series. *The Dinosaur Lords*, a new fantasy series by Victor Milan, is best described by GRRM in his own words as "a cross between *Jurassic Park* and *Game of Thrones*". The book has factions with

combat dinos, which is all for the good but bear in mind that there are at least two books left to conclude *A Song of Ice and Fire*, and there are dinosaurs in *Westeros*. For example, we know there is a velociraptor in the sea lord's palace at *Braavos*, so anything can happen.

One of the great things about this template of the story being told through various first person perspectives, is that not having a reliable narrator inherently opens up the story for interpretation and metadiscussion, encouraging the kind of endless debates on possibilities and theories that makes watching *Game of Thrones* so much fun. MST is an easy recommendation, and there is another announcement. There is a mass market release of the second book in *The New King of Osten Ard* series, *Empire of Grass*, scheduled for June 2021. 



Empire of Grass